November Planting Guide

Central Florida · Ocala · USDA Zone 9a

Shaley Gardens
www.shaleygardens.com

November is prime cool-season time in Central Florida: lower heat and fewer pests make it one of the best months to fill the garden. ★ = keto-friendly pick

🌱 Start in Trays (transplant in 4–6 weeks)

- Broccoli ★, cauliflower ★, cabbage ★
- Brussels sprouts ★, kohlrabi ★
- Lettuce ★ (head and leaf), Chinese cabbage ★
- Celery ★ (slow; start early in month)
- Bunching onions, parsley

🪴 Transplant Now

- Broccoli ★, cabbage ★, cauliflower ★, collards ★, kale ★
- Lettuce ★, Swiss chard ★
- Strawberries: Central FL window is Sept 25–Oct 25 (North FL Oct–Nov). In Ocala, plant any remaining transplants by early November. Try Sweet Sensation, Medallion, Brilliance or Encore.
- Herbs: parsley, cilantro, dill, thyme
- Green/bunching onions, leeks

🌾 Direct Sow

- Radish ★, turnips ★ (greens too), mustard ★
- Spinach ★, arugula ★, lettuce ★
- Carrots, beets ★ (greens), English/snow peas
- Cilantro, dill (succession sow every 2–3 weeks)

🧰 Garden Maintenance

- Add 2–3 in. of mulch; keep it off stems
- Water early in the day; check soil before watering. If you hand-water from a low-pressure well, prioritize new seedlings, transplants and containers, and water deeply at the base instead of sprinkling.
- Side-dress fall crops lightly; soil test if yields lagged
- Scout for caterpillars on brassicas (hand-pick or Bt)
- Pull spent summer crops; compost healthy debris
- Skip lawn fertilizer until spring; clean & sharpen tools

❄️ Freeze Watch

Ocala's average first frost is in late December (Dec 21–31); cold snaps can come as early as late November, and some years see none until January. Most cool-season crops above handle light frost, but cover tender plants (tomatoes, peppers, basil, young transplants) and tropical fruit such as bananas, young citrus and avocado, with frost cloth reaching the ground when lows near 32°F. Water the day before a freeze (hand-watering the root zone is enough), and remove covers once temps rise the next morning. This winter's El Niño may bring wetter weather, so watch drainage too.

Sources: UF/IFAS Extension, *Florida Vegetable Gardening Guide* SP103/VH021, Central Florida planting table, https://edis.ifas.ufl.edu/publication/VH021; UF/IFAS Extension, *Cold Protection of Landscape Plants* (ENH1/MG025), https://edis.ifas.ufl.edu/publication/MG025; UF/IFAS Gardening Solutions, Central Florida Gardening Calendar; PlantMaps, Florida first frost dates (1991–2020). Planting dates are guidelines; adjust for local weather. © Shaley Gardens · www.shaleygardens.com